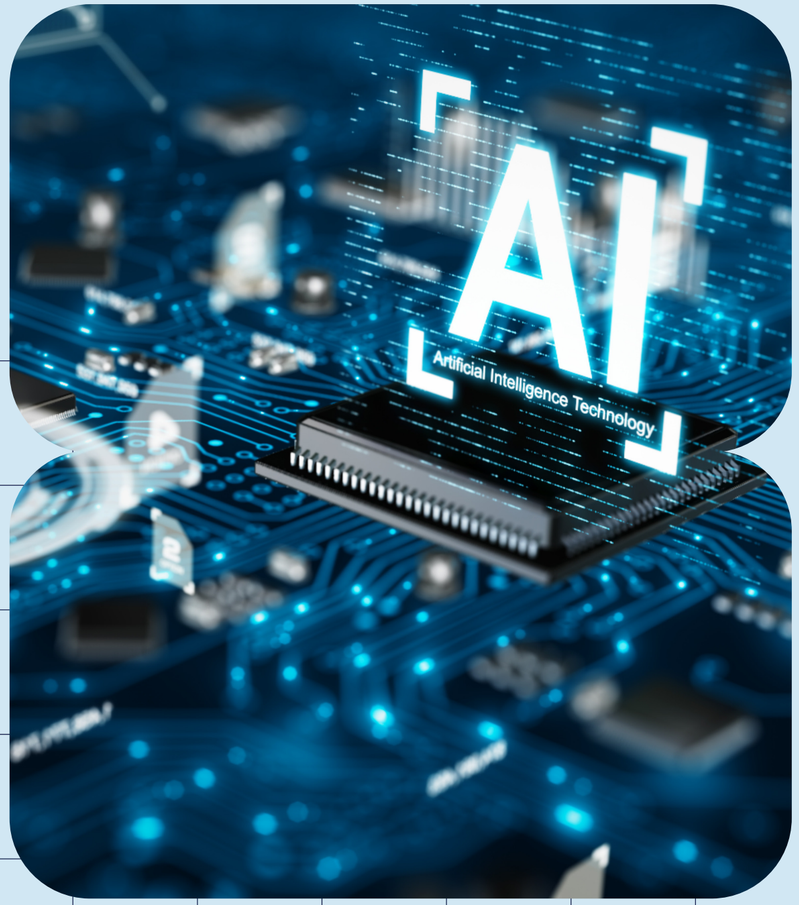
# How AI Coding Tools Are Changing the Future of Software Companies

Could the technology big software companies embrace also help create their competitors?




10/19/2026 Larissa Vigil, Student Name, Student Name

# AI helps developers build software

**Writing code · Debugging · Testing**

GitHub Copilot

Claude Code

Cursor

**90%** surveyed tech professionals use AI at work

**80%** believe AI improves their productivity

Source: Google DORA, 2025 State of AI-assisted Software Development (survey respondents)

# Lower barriers. More competition.

If building becomes easier, what changes for established companies?

01

**Smaller Teams**

May build more with fewer resources

03

**More alternatives**

Open-source and lower-cost competitors

03

**Subscription pressure**

Paid products must demonstrate value

**Nearly two-thirds frustrated with rising subscription prices**

Source: Deloitte, Fall 2026 Digital Media Trends

# Adobe vs. ArtCraft

## Two sides of the same technology

Using AI to improve paid software - and to build free alternatives

### Adobe

Integrating generative AI into established apps

### ArtCraft

7 free, open-source alternatives created with AI coding assistance



# AI Limits, Human Oversight

## Important limitations

ArtCraft is an example of potential, not a full Adobe replacement

**Missing Features** — Independent tests found gaps in functionality

**Usability Problems** — Professional-grade workflows take refinement

**Human Oversight** — Testing, maintenance, and security still matter

**~30%**

reported little or no trust in AI-generated code

Source: TechRadar independent testing; Google DORA (2025)

# What makes software worth paying for?

**AI may empower independent competitors, but reliable products still require human expertise.**

If comparable free alternatives become viable, established companies will have to show what makes their products worth the price.

